The Ziggy & Zeke Social Media Marketing Machine

A Comprehensive System for Building a Viral Brand, Driving Bulk Sales, and Getting Into Schools & Libraries

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Introduction

This document is a complete, actionable marketing system designed to transform **"Ziggy & Zeke: Even When You're Mad"** from a published book into a recognized children's brand that generates consistent sales — particularly through the high-value school and library bulk purchasing channel. This is not a list of suggestions; it is a **machine** — a repeatable system you can execute in 30 minutes a day that compounds over time.

The children's book market has a unique dynamic that works in your favor: the **buyers** (parents, grandparents, teachers, librarians) are not the readers (kids). This means your marketing targets adults who are actively searching for high-quality, values-driven books for the children in their lives. Your book's themes of friendship, forgiveness, and emotional intelligence are not just heartwarming — they align directly with **Social Emotional Learning (SEL)** curricula that schools across the country are actively investing in. That is your competitive advantage, and this machine is built to exploit it.

Your existing social media presence across Facebook, TikTok, and Instagram provides the foundation. Your website at ziggyandzeke.com serves as the central hub. What follows is the strategy, tactics, and tools to turn all of it into a sales-generating engine.

Part 1: Foundation — Optimizing Your Digital Presence

Before launching any campaigns, your digital storefronts must be optimized for trust, professionalism, and conversion. First impressions matter, and every platform should clearly communicate what the book is about, who it is for, and how to buy it.

1.1 Social Media Profile Optimization

Your current profiles are set up, which is a great start. The following table outlines specific enhancements for each platform to maximize their effectiveness.

Platform	Current State	Optimization Actions

Facebook — Ziggy & Zeke	10 followers, cover photo and profile photo set, 1 video post, categories and website linked.	Complete the "About" section with the full story behind the book. Set the primary CTA button to **"Shop Now"** linking to the Amazon sales page. Pin your best-performing post to the top of the page. Add a "Services" section listing author visits and bulk orders.
TikTok — @ziggyandzeke	3 followers, 135 likes, bio includes website link and book description.	Update bio to lead with an emotional hook: *"Helping kids navigate big emotions, one story at a time. 💚 Author: Jeff"*. Replace the direct website link with a **Linktree** or **Beacons** page that links to Amazon, your website, and all social profiles. This maximizes the value of your single link.
Instagram — @ziggyandzekebook	Account created, content status to be confirmed.	Use the same profile picture as TikTok (Ziggy & Zeke illustration) for brand consistency. Write a bio that mirrors TikTok. Create **Instagram Story Highlights** with the following categories: "The Book," "About Jeff," "Reviews," "For Schools," and "Buy Now." These act as a permanent mini-website on your profile.
YouTube — Not yet created	No channel exists.	Create a channel named **"Ziggy & Zeke Official."** Use the book cover illustration as channel art. Write a compelling "About" section telling the story behind the book. Upload a 60-90 second **channel trailer** that introduces you, the book, and what viewers can expect (read-alouds, parenting tips, author journey content).

1.2 Website Enhancements

Your website is live, which is excellent. To support this marketing machine, we need to add two critical elements.

The first is a **"For Schools & Libraries" page**. This dedicated page should include information about author visits (virtual and in-person), bulk pricing tiers, a downloadable sell sheet PDF, and a downloadable teacher's guide PDF. When you email schools and libraries, you will link directly to this page. It gives your outreach immediate credibility and makes it easy for decision-makers to take the next step.

The second is an **email signup mechanism**. Offer a free downloadable Ziggy & Zeke coloring page or activity sheet in exchange for an email address. This builds your email list over time, which becomes one of the most valuable marketing assets you own. Unlike social media followers, you own your email list — no algorithm can take it away.

1.3 Claim Your Book on Goodreads

If you have not already done so, claim your author profile on Goodreads and ensure "Ziggy & Zeke: Even When You're Mad" is listed with the correct cover, description, and purchase links. Goodreads is the largest social network dedicated to books, and many parents and educators use it to discover new titles [2].

Part 2: The Content Engine — What to Post and When

Content is the fuel that powers this machine. The goal is not to post randomly, but to follow a structured system that provides value to your audience, builds your brand, and drives sales — all within your 30-minute daily time budget.

2.1 The Four Content Pillars

Every piece of content you create should fall into one of these four categories. The recommended ratio is approximately 30% Engage, 30% Educate, 20% Connect, and 20% Promote. This ensures you are providing value far more often than you are asking for a sale, which builds trust and loyalty.

Pillar	Purpose	Content Examples
Engage	Create fun, shareable content that captures the spirit of Ziggy & Zeke and encourages interaction.	Character introductions, polls ("Which frog are you?"), kid reaction videos, trending

		audio with book reveals, fan photo reposts.
Educate	Provide genuine value to parents and teachers, positioning you as a trusted voice in children's emotional development.	Parenting tips tied to book themes, SEL explainers, "3 Ways to Help Kids Talk About Anger," read-aloud clips, "5 Books About Friendship" lists.
Connect	Tell your personal story and build an authentic human connection with your audience.	The inspiration behind the book (the real frog video), your adoption story, your military background, behind-the-scenes of the writing process, Q&A sessions.
Promote	Direct calls-to-action to buy the book, book an author visit, or share the book with others.	Book spotlight posts with Amazon links, testimonial graphics, school visit announcements, limited-time offers, "Gift this book" campaigns.

2.2 Posting Schedule and Optimal Times

Research from multiple 2026 studies indicates that posting timing significantly impacts engagement. The following schedule is tailored to your platforms and audience, based on data from Hootsuite, Sprout Social, and WordStream [1].

Platform	Weekly Frequency	Best Days	Best Times (EST)	Content Format
Facebook	4-5 posts	Monday through Thursday	9 AM - 11 AM	Mix of images, short videos, and text posts with links
Instagram	4-5 posts + daily Stories	Monday and Tuesday (feed posts), daily (Stories)	9 AM - 11 AM	Reels (priority), carousel posts, single images, Stories
TikTok	3-4 videos	Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday	2 PM - 5 PM weekdays, 9 AM Saturday	Short-form video (15-60 seconds), trending audio

YouTube	1 video	Friday	Post by 4 PM (algorithm needs indexing time before 6 PM peak)	Long-form (3-8 min) and Shorts

Important note for Jeff: Since you work overnight shifts, the ideal approach is to **batch-create content on your days off** and use scheduling tools (Meta Business Suite for Facebook/Instagram, TikTok's built-in scheduler) to publish at optimal times. This way, your posts go live during peak hours even when you are sleeping or working.

2.3 The 30-Day Launch Calendar

A complete 30-day content calendar with specific content descriptions for each day is included in the accompanying Excel spreadsheet (**"Ziggy_Zeke_Marketing_Machine.xlsx"**). The calendar covers all four platforms and all four content pillars, with detailed descriptions of what to post each day. Here is a summary of the first week to illustrate the rhythm:

Day	Pillar	Platform	Content Summary
Monday (Day 1)	Engage	Instagram + Facebook	Character introduction post with illustration. "Meet Ziggy & Zeke — two best friends who prove that even when you're mad, friendship always wins."
Tuesday (Day 2)	Educate	TikTok	30-second read-aloud clip of the most emotional page with text overlays and trending audio.
Wednesday (Day 3)	Connect	Facebook + Instagram	Personal story: "Why I wrote this book..." Share the real frog rescue video that inspired the story.
Thursday (Day 4)	Educate	Instagram Reels	Quick parenting tip: "3 Ways to Help Kids

			Talk About Anger" — tie each tip back to the book's themes.
Friday (Day 5)	Promote	All Platforms	Book spotlight with Amazon link: "This weekend, give your child the gift of a story about real friendship."
Saturday (Day 6)	Engage	TikTok	Fun behind-the-scenes: Show the book, flip through pages, react to your favorite illustrations.
Sunday (Day 7)	Rest/Engage	Instagram Story	Poll: "Have your kids ever had a big fight with a friend? How did they make up?"

2.4 Hashtag Strategy

Hashtags are your primary discovery mechanism on Instagram and TikTok. The accompanying spreadsheet includes a complete **Hashtag Bank** organized by category, but here is the strategic framework:

Use **10-15 hashtags per Instagram post** and **3-5 hashtags per TikTok video**. Each post should include a mix from these tiers:

Tier	Volume	Purpose	Examples
High-Volume	1M+ posts	Cast a wide net for discovery	#childrensbooks #kidsbooks #bookstagram #picturebooks
Medium-Volume	100K-1M posts	Reach a more targeted audience	#childrensbookauthor #storytime #readaloud #indieauthor

Niche	10K-100K posts	Reach your ideal buyer	#socialemotionallearning #SELforkids #kidsemotions #teachingkindness
Brand	You create these	Build brand recognition over time	#ZiggyAndZeke #EvenWhenYoureMad

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Part 3: Paid Advertising — Amplifying Your Reach

Organic social media builds community, but paid advertising accelerates discovery. Your approach should be **surgical, not spray-and-pray**. The key insight from successful children's book advertisers is that targeting parents with Facebook ads consistently outperforms broad targeting, and connection-driven creative outperforms hard-sell creative [2].

3.1 Facebook & Instagram Ads

Facebook and Instagram ads are managed through the same platform (Meta Ads Manager) and represent your highest-ROI paid channel for reaching parents.

Audience Targeting Setup:

Targeting Layer	Configuration
Demographics	Women, ages 25-45, United States (expand to Canada, UK, Australia once profitable)
Interests	Parenting magazines, children's literature, specific authors (Mo Willems, Eric Carle, Pete the Cat), social-emotional learning, early childhood education, elementary school teachers
Behaviors	Parents with children ages 3-8, engaged shoppers
Exclusions	Exclude people who have already purchased (once you have pixel data)

Ad Creative That Works:

The most effective ad formats for children's books are video ads showing the author reading the book (this builds trust and shows the product in action), carousel ads showcasing beautiful illustrations with story snippets, and testimonial graphics featuring reviews from real parents or educators. You are comfortable on camera, which is a massive advantage — use it.

Budget Strategy:

Start with **$10 per day** split across 2-3 ad variations. Run each variation for 5-7 days to gather data. Kill any ad with a cost-per-click above $1.50 and scale any ad with a cost-per-click below $0.75. Once you find a winning combination, gradually increase the budget by 20% every 3-4 days. Never increase budget by more than 20% at a time, as it disrupts the algorithm's optimization.

3.2 Amazon Advertising

Amazon Sponsored Products ads place your book in front of people who are already searching for children's books — high-intent buyers.

Start with a **$5-$10 per day** budget using **manual keyword targeting**. Target phrases like "children's book about friendship," "kids book about forgiveness," "books about emotions for kids," and "picture book about saying sorry." Also target competitor author names and similar book titles. Monitor your Advertising Cost of Sales (ACoS) weekly — aim for an ACoS below 50% initially, then optimize toward 30% as you gather data.

3.3 Budget Summary

Channel	Daily Budget	Monthly Budget	Primary Goal
Facebook/Instagram Ads	$10-$15	$300-$450	Drive traffic to Amazon, build brand awareness
Amazon Sponsored Products	$5-$10	$150-$300	Capture high-intent buyers on Amazon
Total	**$15-$25**	**$450-$750**	

This is a starting budget. As you identify what works, you can reallocate spend toward the highest-performing channels. The goal is not to spend money — it is to **invest money where it generates a measurable return**.

Part 4: The Bulk Sales Machine — Schools & Libraries

This is the highest-value section of this entire document. A single school district order can generate more revenue than months of individual Amazon sales. Your book's themes of friendship, forgiveness, and emotional intelligence align perfectly with SEL curricula, making it a natural fit for classroom use [3].

4.1 Understanding the School Purchasing Process

Schools are government-funded institutions, which means they do not pay on the spot. The process works as follows: the school issues a **purchase order** (a formal commitment to buy), you fulfill the order by shipping the books and sending an invoice, and the school pays within 30-90 days. This requires some upfront cash flow (to print the books), but the purchase order itself is essentially a guaranteed payment. You can use IngramSpark for bulk printing at significant discounts [3].

4.2 The Outreach Toolkit

Before contacting a single school or library, you need four professional assets prepared and ready to attach to emails or hand out in person.

Asset	Description	Purpose
Professional Sell Sheet	A one-page PDF with the book cover, synopsis, age range, ISBN, author bio, ordering information, and 2-3 testimonials. Include your publisher/company name (not just your personal name).	This is the first thing a librarian or administrator sees. It must look professional and communicate value in 30 seconds.
Teacher's Guide	A 3-5 page PDF with discussion questions, vocabulary words, writing prompts, art activities, and lesson plan ideas tied to the book's themes.	This transforms your book from "just a story" into a **curriculum resource**. Schools love books that come with ready-made teaching materials.
Email Templates	Pre-written, customizable emails for initial outreach, follow-ups, library storytime requests, and bulk order inquiries.	Removes the friction of writing from scratch every time. Five complete templates are included in the accompanying spreadsheet.
Author Visit One-Pager	A simple document outlining your virtual and in-person	Schools have budgets for author visits. This document

	visit options, what the visit includes, duration, and pricing (start with free to build experience and testimonials).	makes it easy for them to say yes.

4.3 The Systematic Outreach Process

This is a numbers game executed with discipline. Here is the step-by-step process:

Step 1 — Build Your Target List. Create a spreadsheet (a template is included in the Excel file) of all elementary schools and public libraries within a 50-mile radius of your location. Include the school name, type (public/private/charter), the librarian's name and email, and the principal's name and email. Most of this information is publicly available on school district websites. Start with 50 targets and expand from there.

Step 2 — Send the Initial Email. Using the email templates provided, send a personalized introductory email to the school librarian (your primary gatekeeper). Attach the sell sheet and teacher's guide. The email should offer a **free review copy** and a **complimentary virtual author visit**. Do not lead with a sales pitch — lead with value.

Step 3 — Follow Up. One week after the initial email, send a brief follow-up email. If you have a phone number, make a short call. The goal of the follow-up is not to close a sale — it is to build a relationship and get a response. Most sales happen after the follow-up, not the initial contact.

Step 4 — Conduct the Visit. For schools that express interest, schedule a 20-30 minute virtual or in-person session. During the visit, read from the book, share the inspiration story (the frog rescue video is gold), and lead a Q&A with the students. Before the visit, work with the school to send **pre-order flyers** home with the children so parents can purchase signed copies.

Step 5 — Secure the Bulk Order. After a successful visit, follow up with the librarian or administrator to discuss purchasing copies for the school library, classroom sets, or the school bookstore. Offer tiered bulk pricing:

Quantity	Discount
10-24 copies	30% off retail
25-49 copies	35% off retail
50+ copies	40% off retail

Step 6 — Get on Reading Lists. Even if a school does not purchase immediately, ask if the book can be added to their recommended reading list or summer reading program. This creates ongoing visibility and future sales opportunities.

4.4 Library-Specific Strategy

Public libraries have a slightly different process. Most have a formal book submission or suggestion process. Contact the children's department directly and offer to lead a **storytime session**. Libraries frequently host author events and are generally more receptive to self-published authors than schools. Bring copies to sell and sign at the event. Ensure your book is available through **IngramSpark** and **Baker & Taylor**, as these are the primary distributors libraries use to order books.

4.5 The Timing Factor

The best time to contact schools is **September through November** — after teachers have settled into the school year but before the holiday rush. For libraries, **spring** is ideal, as many libraries plan their summer reading programs in March and April. Plan your outreach calendar accordingly.

Part 5: Your Daily 30-Minute Routine

This is how the machine runs every single day. Consistency is the secret weapon.

Time Block	Task	Details
Minutes 1-5	Engage	Reply to all comments and DMs across all platforms. Like and comment on 5 posts from accounts in your niche (parents, teachers, other children's book authors).
Minutes 6-15	Create	Create today's content piece based on the content calendar — film a quick video, take a photo, or design a graphic.
Minutes 16-20	Write	Write the caption for today's post. Pull hashtags from the Hashtag Bank in the spreadsheet.

Minutes 21-25	Post	Publish the content to the designated platform(s). Cross-post where applicable.
Minutes 26-30	Outreach	Send 1-2 emails to schools or libraries from your target list, OR engage with 10 new accounts in your target audience.

In addition to the daily routine, dedicate **one hour on your day off** to batch-creating content for the upcoming week. Film 3-4 video clips, design any graphics, and pre-write all captions. Use scheduling tools to queue everything up.

Part 6: Measuring Success — Key Metrics to Track

What gets measured gets managed. Here are the metrics that matter, organized by timeframe.

Timeframe	Metric	Target
Weekly	Social media followers (all platforms combined)	+10-20 new followers per week
Weekly	Engagement rate (likes + comments / followers)	Above 3% on Instagram, above 5% on TikTok
Weekly	Schools/libraries contacted	5 new contacts per week
Monthly	Amazon book sales	Track via KDP dashboard
Monthly	Ad spend vs. revenue (ROAS)	Aim for 2:1 return or better
Monthly	Email list growth	+20-50 new subscribers per month
Quarterly	School/library visits completed	3-5 per quarter
Quarterly	Bulk orders secured	1-2 per quarter (this grows over time)

Conclusion

This marketing machine is designed to work within your real-world constraints — 30 minutes a day, a reasonable ad budget, and the understanding that you are building something sustainable, not chasing overnight virality. The combination of consistent social media content, targeted paid advertising, and systematic school and library outreach creates a three-pronged approach where each channel reinforces the others.

Your book's themes are timely and needed. Your personal story as a military veteran, adoptee, and 35-year broadcasting professional gives you a unique and authentic voice that resonates with audiences. The frog rescue video that inspired the story is the kind of origin story that goes viral when told well.

The full 30-day content calendar, weekly posting checklist, school outreach tracker, five ready-to-send email templates, and complete hashtag bank are all included in the accompanying Excel spreadsheet. Start with Day 1 of the calendar and execute consistently. The machine will build momentum over time.

Now here is my question for you, Jeff: **Which part of this machine do you want to fire up first?** The social media content engine, the paid ads, or the school outreach campaign? Starting with one and building momentum before adding the next is often more effective than trying to launch everything simultaneously.

References

[1] WordStream. (2026, January 7). Best Times to Post on Social Media in 2026 [For Every Platform].

[2] Reedsy. (2025, October 15). 4 Tips to Market Children's Books, According to a Bestselling Author.

[3] IngramSpark. (2024, April 23). Getting Your Book into Schools.

[4] Keboto. (2025, March 20). How to Market and Promote Your Children's Book to Schools and Libraries.